



KNOW HOW



❶ I have just bought a new Compaq 520 laptop. It comes with a Web camera and an inbuilt microphone with speakers. I have installed Ubuntu 9.10 on it that came bundled with *LFY*. Every thing is working fine but I am unable to test my Web camera. I have checked *dmesg* and can make out that Ubuntu has recognised my camera. Can you please suggest a solution?

—*Arnab Sen, Ghaziabad*

You'll need a webcam application that works on Ubuntu. I would suggest you install Cheese — I think it should have been installed by default. Cheese uses your webcam to take photos and videos; it works with GNOME 2.28 and is built on GStreamer with GTK, Cairo and D-Bus. Just in case it's not already available on your system, install it as follows (provided you're connected to the Internet):

```
sudo apt-get update
```

...and then:

```
sudo apt-get install cheese
```

❷ I like to fiddle around with various distros and would like to employ virtualisation for the purpose. However, my system's processor does not have support for hardware virtualisation. My system has a 2 GHz Core 2 Duo, a 5400 RPM hard disk and 3 GB of DDR2 800 MHz RAM. I am currently running 32-bit Kubuntu 9.10 on it. I was wondering if you could let me know which software-based virtualisation solution will provide the best performance for my needs (from among the FOSS ones, of course :-), i.e., enable the best performance of the guest OS.

—*Saurav Sengupta, Chandigarh*

Have a look at VirtualBox. It comes under two licences. The fully open source version is available in the software repository of most Linux distros. Its project website, www.virtualbox.org, hosts the closed-source binaries (which have a few additional features). You can also try their IRC or forum at www.virtualbox.org/wiki/Community for any help needed while installing and configuring it.

❸ I have an old assembled desktop PC with a P IV 1.7 GHz processor and 1 GB RAM. The motherboard is Mercury with an Intel 845 chipset. I was trying to install openSUSE 11.1 on the system but wasn't successful. The installation went fine for me but after the first reboot, I could not get the graphical screen to configure my system. I have tried restarting several times but the problem remains the same. I

have installed the same OS on my latest Core 2 Duo-based system and it is working flawlessly. Is there a way to make it work on my old system, too?

—*Sudhakar M, Bangalore*

openSUSE should work flawlessly on your old system too. I would suggest you set the Frame Buffer Size to 8 MB in the video section of your system BIOS. After setting it, try booting your system—your X should work.

❹ I have an Acer E725 (eMachine) that comes with a Pentium Dual core processor and 1 GB of RAM. I have installed Ubuntu 9.10 on it. Everything works fine but I am unable to configure the wireless feature on it. *lspci* shows that it has a Broadcom Wireless (BCM 4211) but System → Administrator → Hardware Drivers shows that all the drivers work.

—*Sonali Roy, New Delhi*

To resolve this issue I would suggest the following steps:

- Place your Ubuntu 9.10 Live CD in the drive
- Open the Synaptic package manager
- Go to Settings → Repositories
- Check the option that says *Installable from CD*.
- Refresh
- Now search and install the *bcmwl-kernel-source* package
- Restart your computer

Next, go to System → Administrator → Hardware Drivers. Select Broadcom STA and Broadcom fwcuttler, click on *Activate* and restart. Configure your wireless network and surf the Web. 